Rice beverages, rice milk,: HMTc Standard

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CORRESPONDENCE

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KEYWORDS

heavy metals, food safety, dietary exposure

PUBLICATION HISTORY

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Abstract

The Heavy Metal Tested & Certified standard for rice beverages (rice milk), stated as consumed. The EU sets a dedicated inorganic-arsenic maximum for non-alcoholic rice drinks (30 ppb), which is the binding arsenic control; every limit is the strictest maximum level any credible government sets for the product.

1 | How every number on this standard is set

HMTc Method v2.0 (government-limit default, 8:1 basis, read-across)

2 | Master limit table

All values in ppb (µg/kg), as consumed basis. A brand meeting every value qualifies for the mark.

ANALYTE	TIER	HMTC LIMIT	BASIS
Lead (Pb)	Tier 1	50	human-grade read-across (Mercosur)
Cadmium (Cd)	Tier 1	2	human-grade read-across (AU)
Total arsenic (tAs)	Tier 2	50	human-grade read-across (Mercosur)
Inorganic arsenic (iAs)	Tier 1	30	government maximum level

Mercury, total (tHg)	Tier 1	1	human-grade read-across (European Union)
Methylmercury (MeHg)	Tier 1	≤ tHg	bounded by tHg (reflex speciation)
Nickel (Ni)	Tier 2	250	human-grade read-across (European Union)
Tin (Sn)	Tier 2	100,000	human-grade read-across (European Union)
Aluminium (Al)	Tier 2	200	human-grade read-across (European Union)
Total chromium (Cr)	Tier 2	50	human-grade read-across (AU)
Hexavalent chromium (Cr-VI)	Tier 2	10	human-grade read-across (US-CA)

3 | Derivation — where each number comes from

Every cell traces to one named sovereign maximum level (the strictest for the nearest analog), or to an explicit control, not-material, or species-bounded determination. No occurrence statistic selects a certification value.

ANALYTE	HMTC	SOVEREIGN ANALOG / DETERMINATION
Lead (Pb)	50	Mercosur — human-food analog
Cadmium (Cd)	2	AU — human-food analog
Total arsenic (tAs)	50	Mercosur — human-food analog
Inorganic arsenic (iAs)	30	government maximum level
Mercury, total (tHg)	1	European Union — human-food analog
Methylmercury (MeHg)	≤ tHg	MeHg carries no product-specific sovereign cell; it is a component of and bounded by its parent total tHg (MeHg <= tHg), an enforceable ceiling via reflex speciation rather than an empty cell.
Nickel (Ni)	250	European Union — human-food analog
Tin (Sn)	100,000	European Union — human-food analog

Aluminium (Al)	200	European Union — human-food analog
Total chromium (Cr)	50	AU — human-food analog
Hexavalent chromium (Cr-VI)	10	US-CA — human-food analog

4 | Cite this standard

Pendergrass, K. "Rice beverages, rice milk,." In Heavy Metal Tested & Certified (HMTc) Grains, Cereals, and Rice Products standard, version 1.0 (2026-08-10). Institute of Contaminant Standards (ICS), 2026.

References

[1] AU — human-food maximum levels
Binds Cd, Cr. Strictest applicable human-food sovereign maximum for the nearest analog.
MAXIMUM LEVEL

[2] European Union — human-food maximum levels
Binds tHg, Ni, Sn, Al. Strictest applicable human-food sovereign maximum for the nearest analog.
MAXIMUM LEVEL

[3] Mercosur — human-food maximum levels
Binds Pb, tAs. Strictest applicable human-food sovereign maximum for the nearest analog.
MAXIMUM LEVEL

[4] US-CA — human-food maximum levels
Binds Cr-VI. Strictest applicable human-food sovereign maximum for the nearest analog.
MAXIMUM LEVEL

STATUS AND LICENCE

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DATA AVAILABILITY

The works this reference draws on are listed in full in the references above and on the briefing page at https://heavymetalcertified.com/standards/rice--beverages-rice-milk. Primary legal instruments and expert-body assessments are named with their public identifiers; the underlying occurrence and toxicology corpus is maintained on the Heavy Metal Index.

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